

grammatical issues. Also, tell them to be honest about what they think. If you can, show it to a few other people, and get a consensus going. It will help you in the long run. These foundations and agencies like to see well-written applications, so hit your friends up for some favors and get some opinions.

Send It

Once you've worked any kinks out, and you're happy with your application, it's time to send it out! Be sure to know what the deadline is in advance, so you're not disappointed if you suddenly find out you're too late. If that's the case, you'll have to wait until next year. However, there's no need to worry – there are so many grants out there, and they're all going on at different times. You can always find something to apply for. You just have to look. Since I've already pointed you in the right direction, that shouldn't be too difficult!

Celebrate It

Your application's out there, and that's a reason to celebrate. The potential for free money is now closer than it ever was before. Some grants will get back to you within weeks, others will take months. Whatever the timeframe is, be patient. Put it out of your mind, and if there are other grant applications you'd like to apply for, go for it. You might as well. The process is so utterly simple; what have you got to lose?

If you want to know more about how to write grant proposals, there's a great amount of information here too: www.nonprofit.about.com/od/fundraising/ht/proposals.htm.